

needs then you can go for a tablet that has both the features. The iBall Slide 3GQ1035, for example, can connect using 2G, 3G and Wi-Fi networks.

Price

Like smartphones and other tablets, 25.4cm devices are also available across a wide price range. This display size though won't be available in the below ₹ 15,000 range, also known as the budget range. The iBall Slide mentioned above is priced at around ₹ 18,000.

25.4cm devices are available for ₹ 16,000 onward, going well beyond ₹ 50,000. The Apple iPad Air and Samsung Galaxy Note 10.1 are high-end devices priced around ₹ 50,000. But these are immensely powerful devices, which would often be more than what you need. On the other hand, for hardcore gadget fans, the unparalleled performance that these bring would be a treasure.

Calling or non-calling

Many people may like to replace their smartphone with a tablet. In our humble opinion, your smartphone should be a companion of your tablet (especially if you are buying iPad). However, tablets can be used for phone calls and can replace smartphones if you want. Just a suggestion, go for a Bluetooth or other headset if you intend to use a 25.4cm tablet for calling purposes as well.

There are myriad offerings from companies like Xolo, iBall and many others. The tablets are usually priced over ₹ 20,000.

Build

At this point you may be wondering how two 25.4cm tablets differ in their build, form factor, etc. Well, in theory they should not, but they can and they do. The build of a device plays a huge role in its portability. A slim device like Apple's iPad Air would be much easier to carry around than others.

Another example of the build quality is that seen in Lenovo Yoga 10

tablets. These tablets can be docked without a cover or keyboard, allowing you comfortable setups for Skyping with family, watching movies, etc. The build of Lenovo Yoga 10 has been liked by most users.

Also important is the weight of the device. Lesser the weight, easier it is to carry the device through crowded public transport and on long journeys.

Operating system

The operating system is a factor that everyone looks at while buying a tablet or laptop. Here's how we suggest you choose yours. The premise from the beginning has been that you are going to use your tablet as a replacement for your laptop. Let's face it, nothing quite matches the functionality and wide usage that Microsoft's Windows presents when it comes to PCs. Unfortunately, there are not many Windows options available for tablets. The Asus Transformer Book T100 is a good Windows tablet though, which easily passes as a notebook when docked.

Others like the Samsung Galaxy Note 10.1 that we have mentioned here run on Apple's iOS or Google Android operating system. You will find that both these OSs are good replacements for Windows. The fact that Microsoft leads in the OS segment has more to do with users being comfortable with the OS on their PC and not wanting to try new ones. Android has apps like QuickOffice which replaces MS Office. In addition, it also has apps for Skype and virtually everything you need.

Conclusion

A 25.4cm tablet can be a perfect replacement for a notebook. In fact, if you look at Asus Transformer series, you will find devices that replicate notebooks, a genre that the company is often attributed to have pioneered. Further, if you happen to buy an iPad Air, iPad with Retina Display or Galaxy Note 10.1, you will get much more power than your netbook offered. ●

The author was working with EYF as a correspondent till recently

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